

SCULPTED HISTORY
A view of the gallery and (below) a vessel, or krater, a type of ancient Greek pottery that was used to mix wine and water

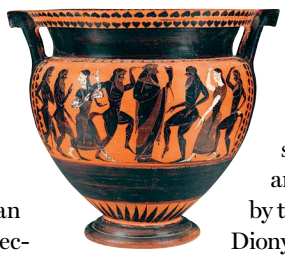
ART

Treasures of Antiquity

***Ancient Sculptures* at the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya, Mumbai, showcases sculptures from the great civilisations of yore alongside Indian sculptures from the museum's own collection**

Surmounting the impediments that geographical boundaries once posed, 19 art treasures of the great civilisations of antiquity (2nd century BCE to 5th century CE), mostly loaned from leading international institutions and museums, have assembled since December 2 last year in the Rotunda Gallery of the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya (CSMVS), Mumbai. The museum's vaulting dome soars above this vast hall. This exhibition, titled *Ancient Sculptures: India, Egypt, Assyria, Greece, Rome,* and planned in association with CSMVS's special international partners—the Getty, British Museum, Staatliche Museen Zu Berlin as well as leading Indian museums—will afford Indians the rare opportunity of viewing and interpreting in their own way these original objects, till October 1.

Curators from CSMVS, along with their colleagues from the participating museums, have chosen from the perspective of young Indians the sculptures exhibited alongside 100 Indian objects from their own collection. "The exhibition, as a unique and important educational endeavour, provides our Indian audiences and students with new ways of viewing their own culture as a result of seeing it in relation to other societies and geographies," says Sabyasachi Mukherjee, CSMVS director-general.



The exhibition explores three themes—divinities manifested in physical form; Nature; and the concept of beauty. The perfect gymnasium-toned marmoreal torso of Apollo, the sun god who stood for harmony, order and reason, is counterpoised by the dégagé figure of a young Dionysius, the god of intoxica-